

What is a stem?

A stem is like a plant's backbone, holding it up and connecting its roots, leaves, flowers, and fruits. It raises the leaves toward the sunlight so they can make food, which is then transported by the stem to the rest of the plant. It also carries water and nutrients up from the roots. There are many different types of stems, from soft, green stems to hard tree trunks.

Sugarcane

Tough stem ➤ This tall grass supports itself with a tough stem. Special tissues running down the stem transport the sugar made in its leaves to other parts of the plant. Sugarcane stems hold a lot of sugar, which can be harvested and dried to produce the sugar that we eat.

Creeper stem ➤ Young English ivy stems are soft and flexible, with tiny anchoring roots to help it climb. As the plant grows, the stems grow thicker and harder, sending out side shoots to explore new spaces.

English ivy